

Data Classification & Handling Policy

1. Purpose

This policy establishes a data classification framework for Robotix Technologies and defines handling requirements for each classification level. Properly classifying and handling data reduces the risk of unauthorized disclosure, regulatory non-compliance, and reputational harm. All employees who create, receive, process, or store Robotix Technologies data are responsible for applying these standards.

2. Scope

This policy applies to:

All Robotix Technologies data in any format: digital files, email, printed documents, verbal communications, and data at rest or in transit.

All employees, contractors, and third parties who handle Robotix Technologies data.

All systems used to create, store, process, or transmit Robotix Technologies data, including Microsoft 365 (OneDrive, SharePoint, Exchange), Slack, Zoom, local device storage, and external media.

3. Policy Statements

3.1 Data Classification Levels

Robotix Technologies uses four data classification levels:

Level

Label

Description

Examples

1

2

Public

Internal

Approved for unrestricted distribution outside Robotix Technologies

Marketing materials, published blog posts, job postings, public pricing

Not intended for external distribution; low harm if disclosed

Internal announcements, general IT procedures, meeting agendas, org charts

(cid:127) (cid:127) (cid:127)

3

4

Confidential

Restricted

Sensitive business information; significant harm if disclosed

Highly sensitive; disclosure could cause severe harm or legal liability

Client contracts, financial reports, strategic plans, employee salary data, vendor agreements

Personal health information (PHI), personal financial data, credentials, encryption keys, regulated personal data, M&A data

3.1.1 Data without an explicit classification label is treated as Internal by default until properly reviewed and labeled.

3.1.2 Employees who create documents must apply the appropriate classification label. In Microsoft 365, this is achieved using Microsoft Purview sensitivity labels (visible in Office apps under the Sensitivity toolbar button):

Label in Purview

Classification

Public

Internal

Confidential

Highly Confidential

Public

Internal

Confidential

Restricted

3.1.3 SharePoint libraries and Teams channels that hold Confidential or Restricted data must have the appropriate Purview container label applied by the site owner. IT Security conducts quarterly audits of label coverage.

3.2 Handling Requirements by Classification Level

3.2.1 Public Data

(cid:127) May be shared freely via any channel, including external email, social media, and public websites.

No special storage, access control, or disposal requirements beyond normal records retention.

3.2.2 Internal Data

(cid:127) May be shared with all Robotix Technologies employees and authorized contractors.

(cid:127) Must not be shared externally without manager approval.

(cid:127)

Store in SharePoint, OneDrive for Business, or other IT-approved repositories. Do not store on personal cloud storage.

Dispose of printed copies in standard recycling if they contain no Confidential or Restricted elements.

3.2.3 Confidential Data

Handling Aspect

Requirement

Access

Storage

Email

External sharing

Printing

Need-to-know basis; controlled via SharePoint/OneDrive permissions and Okta group membership

SharePoint/OneDrive with "Confidential" sensitivity label; encrypted at rest

Encrypt outbound email via Microsoft Purview; mark subject with [CONFIDENTIAL]

Requires manager and Legal approval; use Microsoft Purview protected sharing

Print using PaperCut Secure Print (release at MFP with badge/PIN); retrieve immediately

Physical documents

Store in locked cabinets when not in use

Disposal

Transmission

Removable media

3.2.4 Restricted Data

Shred using cross-cut shredder or locked shred bins; do not place in general recycling

Must be encrypted in transit (TLS 1.2+); do not send via unsecured channels

Prohibited for Confidential data unless encrypted USB approved by IT; log usage in ticket

Handling Aspect

Requirement

Access

Storage

Strictly limited; access requires explicit approval from data owner and IT Security

Designated Restricted SharePoint sites or approved secure repositories only; "Highly Confidential" label required

(cid:127) (cid:127)

Email

External sharing

Printing

Physical documents

Disposal

Transmission

Encrypted end-to-end; avoid emailing Restricted data where possible; use secure file share instead

Requires VP-level approval, Legal review, and executed NDA/DPA with recipient; use Purview protected link only

Prohibited unless explicitly approved by data owner; if approved, use Secure Print and immediately place in locked document bag

Two-person rule for transport; locked in fire-rated safe when not in active use

On-site cross-cut shredding per NIST 800-88 guidelines; documented destruction certificate required

Encrypted in transit (TLS 1.3 preferred); consider Purview Information Protection or secure file transfer solution

Removable media

Prohibited

Screen visibility

3.3 Data Labeling

Laptop screens must use privacy screens; avoid displaying in public spaces

3.3.1 Employees must apply the correct Purview sensitivity label at the time of document creation. Labels are available in Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook, and Teams.

3.3.2 Purview auto-labeling policies are configured to detect common Restricted data patterns (credit card numbers, Social Security Numbers, health information keywords) and apply the Highly Confidential label automatically. Employees must not override auto-applied labels to a lower classification without written approval from the data owner.

3.3.3 Physical documents containing Confidential or Restricted data must be stamped or header/footer labeled with the appropriate classification level on every page.

3.4 Data Storage Locations

Approved storage locations by classification:

Classification

Approved Locations

Prohibited Locations

Public

Internal

Confidential

Restricted

3.5 Data Retention

SharePoint, OneDrive, external websites

N/A

SharePoint, OneDrive, Teams, company laptop local drive

Personal cloud (Dropbox, iCloud personal, Google Drive personal)

SharePoint (labeled), OneDrive (labeled), encrypted archive

Unencrypted email attachments, Slack (direct messages), USB without encryption

Designated Restricted SharePoint sites, approved vault systems

Any non-IT-approved location; Slack; Teams general channels; email

Data must be retained and disposed of in accordance with POL-011 (Data Backup & Retention Policy). Employees must not delete data subject to a legal hold or regulatory retention requirement. Legal hold notifications are issued by the Legal team via email and the RobotixDesk portal.

3.6 Data Breach Notification

Any suspected loss, theft, or unauthorized disclosure of Confidential or Restricted data must be reported to the Security Operations Center immediately at soc@robotix.com or via #it-help on Slack, 24/7. Incidents involving Restricted (especially regulated) data trigger the Incident Response process; IT Security will notify Legal and, if required, affected individuals or regulators within required timeframes.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role

Responsibility

All Employees

Data Owners (business unit leaders)

IT Security & Compliance

L3 Engineering

Classify data at creation; apply Purview labels; handle data per this policy; report suspected breaches

Define classification for data in their domain; approve access to Confidential/Restricted data; review classification quarterly

Own policy; configure Purview DLP and labeling; conduct audits; manage breach response

Configure SharePoint/OneDrive permissions, Purview policies, and DLP rules

Legal

HR

Advise on regulatory requirements; issue legal holds; approve Restricted data external sharing

Ensure employee classification training completion; support investigations

5. Enforcement & Consequences

Mishandling of data according to its classification level is a serious policy violation:

Labeling omissions or errors (unintentional): Correction required; additional training.

Storing Confidential/Restricted data in unapproved locations: Written warning; data moved to approved location; IT review of other storage.

Sharing Confidential/Restricted data without authorization: HR investigation; suspension of data access; potential termination.

Data breach resulting from policy non-compliance: HR/Legal investigation; possible termination; regulatory and legal consequences.

6. Exceptions

Exceptions (e.g., business need to store Restricted data in a non-standard system) must be approved by the data owner, IT Security & Compliance, and Legal. All exceptions must document compensating controls and have an expiration date not exceeding 90 days.

7. Related Documents

POL-001 - Acceptable Use Policy

POL-008 - Email & Communications Policy

POL-009 - Access Control & Least Privilege Policy

POL-011 - Data Backup & Retention Policy

REF-0001 - Robotix IT Environment Standards

(cid:127) Microsoft Purview Labeling Guide (internal wiki)

Data Breach Response Runbook (internal runbook)

8. Revision History

Version

Date

Author

1.0

2020-11-01

IT Security

Summary of Changes

Initial data classification framework (three levels)

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2.0

2.1

2022-06-01

IT Security & Compliance

2023-04-15

IT Security & Compliance

3.0

2024-01-15

IT Security & Compliance

3.0.1

2025-10-01

IT Security & Compliance

Robotix IT Service Desk · Synthetic knowledge base · This document is fictional sample data.

Added Restricted tier; introduced Microsoft Purview labeling

Added auto-labeling policy details; updated removable media prohibition for Restricted data

Full rewrite; comprehensive handling tables per tier; aligned to Purview container labels; added SharePoint site labeling audit requirement

Annual review; updated prohibited storage list; no structural changes

Robotix Technologies — Internal IT Documentation · Synthetic data, no PII.